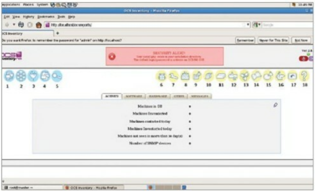

Figure 6: OCS initial screen

5. This is to search computers using a name, like, IP Addr, MAC addr, cpu, architecture and many more. And you can use multiple operators to compare groups.
6. This deploys and activates packages/apps. First, you have to build the package and deploy it on client servers. The important attributes for building a package bundle are:
   a) Priority: Level 0 to 9. 9 is the least and 0 is the highest priority. This will be used to decide which package has to be installed first when deploying multiple packages.
   b) File: Zip for window and tar.gz for Linux.
   c) Action – Store: Just download the bundle at the client server.
   d) Execute: This will deploy and execute the installer file from the bundle. Either *.exe* for Windows or an rpm in the case of Linux. It will just execute the command from the command box and won't return anything like 'success' or 'failure'.
   e) Launch: This is to deploy a bundle with the command and it will return the value. Here you can use your own script to deploy patches.
   f) You can configure the user notification if you want to notify users.

   Once done, you can activate the bundle to make it ready for deployment.
7. Config: You can configure the default attributes related to the server, IPDiscovery. We will discuss a few important attributes below:
   a) Frequency: This refers to the frequency (in days) to collect inventory.
   b) Inventory_Diff: This is for whether to enable differential inventory or not (like differential backup).
   c) Inventory Transaction: If this is enabled, it will not store inventory information in case of any partial error.
   d) IPDiscover: This is to find the number of agents running IPDiscovery per subnet.
   e) Deploy: This is for whether to enable automatic deployment or not.
   f) Download_timeout: This is the maximum time a package can take to download to the client. If it exceeds the limit, cancel the download and log error message.
   g) Local_port: This is the TCP port of the OCS communication server.
   h) Local_server: This is the communication server's name.
   i) Loglevel: This is the level of log creation. */var/log/ocsinventory-NG* for Linux and *<appfolder>\xampp\apache\logs* for Windows.
   j) LDAP configuration: This is to configure LDAP credentials.
8. IP Discover: This is to auto discover the devices in a network or subnet. This feature will auto discover servers in a network.
9. Registry: This modifies Windows' registry values.
10. Administrative data: This stores custom data for each server. For example, you may store the data centre's name, rack number, etc, by creating custom values here.
11. Duplicates: This checks duplicates of IP, hostname and mac address, or a combination of all these parameters.
12. Dictionary: This categorises the detected packages manually.
    a. New: Uncategorised softwares/packages
    b. Ignored: Cannot import GLPI under these packages
    c. Unchanged: The packages under this category will be imported, as is
13. Plugins: This lists installed plugins and the management of these plugins.
14. Logs: This views the logs and imports them as *.csv* files too.
15. Statistics: This gets the statistics about valid connections and failed connections, as well as successful and errored deployments.
16. Users: This creates users with different roles like Super admin/Admin/requester.
    a. Super admin: Can change the entire configuration
    b. Admin: Can add/modify users and has fewer controls
    c. Requester: Has no modification access
17. Local import: Another good feature in OCS is that you can maintain inventory for non-networked servers also. You can run the inventory agent and export the file as a *.ocs* file from source, and import the same in the admin console using this option. So you can include servers in DMZ without actually connecting to it.
18. Help: Shows the wiki page for more help.

The list of options is very long. We can see what information we get from the inventory through the screenshots given in Figures 4, 5, and 6.

The inventory will list all the details of the installed hardware and software as shown in these figures. There are many customisations which can be done in OCS. Remember that these are only Linux agents. END

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